

Signal of the week

Kigen wins first GSMA eSA certification for SGP.32 v1.3 automotive eSIM

Arm's Kigen unit earned GSMA SGP.32 v1.3 automotive eSIM certification, paired with Infineon's TEGRION SLI22. OEM sampling in ETSI MFF2 begins October 2026; China Mobile International is connectivity partner.

Why it matters — Sets the reference eSIM stack competing directly with Cubic³ orchestration for long-life vehicle fleets.

Sources: Kigen press release (media-outreach.com) (2026-09-29) · IoT Business News (2026-09-29)

Where the activity was

	SDV	Connect-ivity	AI	Data mgmt	Digital twins
Automotive	3	2	1	1	0
Robotics / AV	4	0	4	1	0
Fleets	1	3	2	3	0
Energy	2	2	1	3	0
Agri / industrial	1	0	3	1	0

Qualifying items this week (score ≥ 6): none 1-2 3-5 6+

Automotive OEMs

Data mgmt SDV

EU Data Act design-by-default duties bite on connected vehicles

EU Data Act design-by-default obligations applied from 12 September 2026, requiring connected vehicle makers to embed real-time third-party data access.

So what — Every European connected car sold from now must ship with open data access as standard.

vxlabs.ai regulatory brief, 2026-09-12

Robotics and autonomous vehicles

AI SDV

Wayve signs Nissan, Uber and Mercedes-Benz for AI autonomy

Wayve partnered with Nissan and Uber to launch a Tokyo robotaxi service combining Wayve's AI with Nissan ProPilot, and separately signed Mercedes-Benz to embed its stack in Mercedes SDV platforms.

So what — Positions Wayve as the leading independent autonomy licensor across three major OEM programmes.

TechCrunch Mobility, 2026-09-27

The read-across

Regulation is the through-line this week. The EU Data Act's design-by-default duties applied from 12 September, and by month-end Wialon, High-Mobility and Flespi were shipping OEM-native data pipelines to fleets. Six of 18 qualified items touch a named Cubic³ account.

The heat-map shows SDV and AI concentrating in automotive and robotics, whilst data and connectivity dominate fleets and energy.

75 items screened 19 qualified (score ≥ 6) 6 account-relevant

SDV AI

SoundHound launches on-device agentic voice AI for vehicles

SoundHound unveiled OASYS Edge on 24 September 2026, an embedded LLM voice system running agentic reasoning fully on-device.

So what — Shifts cockpit AI inference from cloud to edge, reducing dependence on cellular data pipes.

SoundHound Investor Newsroom, 2026-09-24

AI SDV Data mgmt

Uber commits \$10bn to AVs with Rivian and Avride deals

Uber announced roughly \$10bn in AV investment, including \$7.5bn for fleet procurement and a Rivian deal for 10,000 robotaxis, with an option for 50,000 by 2030.

So what — Reshapes the robotaxi supply chain with Uber owning fleet capital rather than platform rides.

Smart Cities Dive (citing FT), 2026-09-22

Fleets

Data mgmt Connectivity

Wialon opens OEM-native vehicle data to fleets via High-Mobility and Flespi

Wialon established a data pipeline via High-Mobility and Flespi, giving fleet owners direct, warranty-safe OEM vehicle data without aftermarket hardware, framed as an EU Data Act compliance response.

So what — Removes the aftermarket dongle from fleet telematics for EU operators using Wialon.

Work Truck Online, 2026-09-09

AI Connectivity

SoftBank launches NVIDIA GB200 AI data-centre GPU cloud in October

SoftBank is launching its AI Data Centre GPU Cloud in October 2026 using NVIDIA GB200 NVL72 systems in Japanese data centres, integrated with its mobile network as distributed AI-RAN infrastructure.

So what — Gives SoftBank a native latency-sensitive AI hosting layer adjacent to its mobile network.

TelecomLead, 2026-09-30

Energy

SDV Data mgmt

VW's Elli launches commercial V2G package in Germany

Elli commercially launched its V2G package in Germany — a DC bidirectional charger, Volkswagen Naturstrom V2G Flow tariff and Elli BiDi App — targeting around 360,000 V2G-ready vehicles. ID.

So what — First European OEM to package V2G hardware, tariff and app as a retail bundle.

Elli / Volkswagen Group Newsroom, 2026-10-01

SDV Connectivity

GM commits all future EVs to V2G and ISO 15118 standards

GM committed to V2G capability across all planned future EV models. Its current fleet of around 250,000 V2G-capable vehicles could power 120,000 homes for a week.

So what — Locks in bidirectional charging across GM's future range using an open communication standard.

GM Newsroom, 2026-06-09

Agri and industrial OEMs

AI SDV

Applied Intuition launches Dana agentic AI platform with Komatsu

Applied Intuition launched Dana, an agentic AI platform unifying data curation, simulation, training, evaluation and deployment for safety-critical machines.

So what — Places Komatsu on a shared autonomy toolchain with automotive and defence customers.

Automotive World, 2026-07-21

AI Data mgmt

John Deere unveils JD AI Assistant at Farm Progress Show

John Deere unveiled its JD AI Assistant at Farm Progress Show 2026, an AI copilot analysing field, machine and operational data.

So what — Puts a native Deere copilot against telematics-hub rivals for mixed-fleet farm data.

AgriTech Magazine, 2026-09-28

Deals and partnerships logged this week

Who	With	What	Domain	Relevance
Wayve	Nissan, Uber, Mercedes-Benz	Tokyo robotaxi launch and Mercedes SDV integration	Robotics / AV	Prospect
Arm Kigen	Infineon, China Mobile International	First SGP.32 v1.3 automotive eSIM certified, OEM sampling Oct 2026	Automotive	Competitive
Uber	Rivian	10,000 robotaxis, option to 50,000 by 2030 (~\$10bn)	Robotics / AV	Prospect
Wialon	High-Mobility, Flespi	Native OEM data pipeline for fleet operators	Fleets	Partner

Watch list

Verizon Connect finds AI video telematics adoption at 46%. Video AI has crossed from early adopter to mainstream fleet telematics feature.